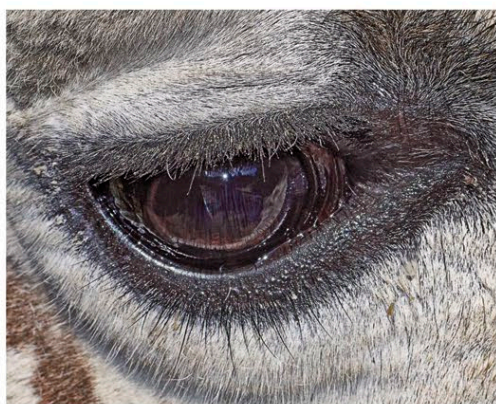


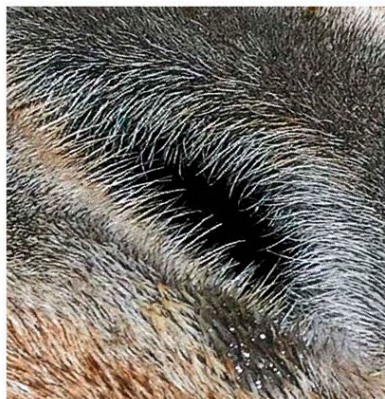


^ EYE

The large eyes on the side of the head have excellent vision. This, combined with the giraffe's height, allows them to spot predators while they are still some distance away.

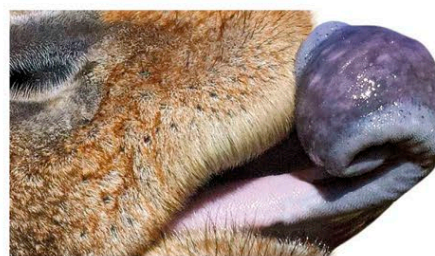
✓ NOSTRIL

The nostrils can close to prevent debris from entering the nasal passages during sand and dust storms, and act as a barrier to ants while feeding.



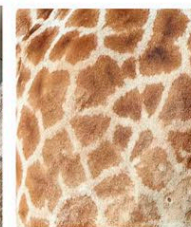
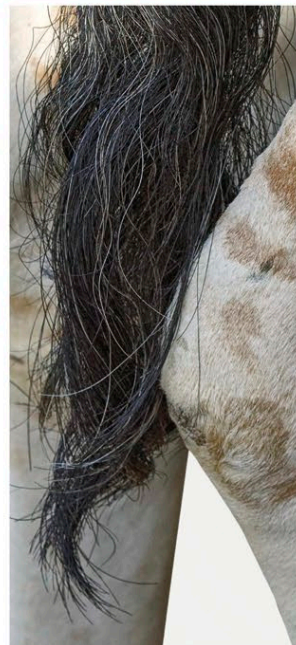
TAIL >

The tail can be up to 2.5 m (8 ft) long, and the tuft of black hair at its tip is used to deter insects.



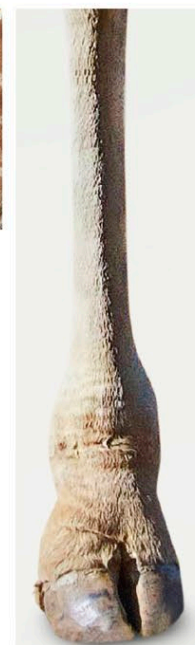
< CURLED TONGUE

The prehensile tongue and upper lip can pluck buds from between the thorns of a tree as well as strip a branch of its leaves.



^ SKIN

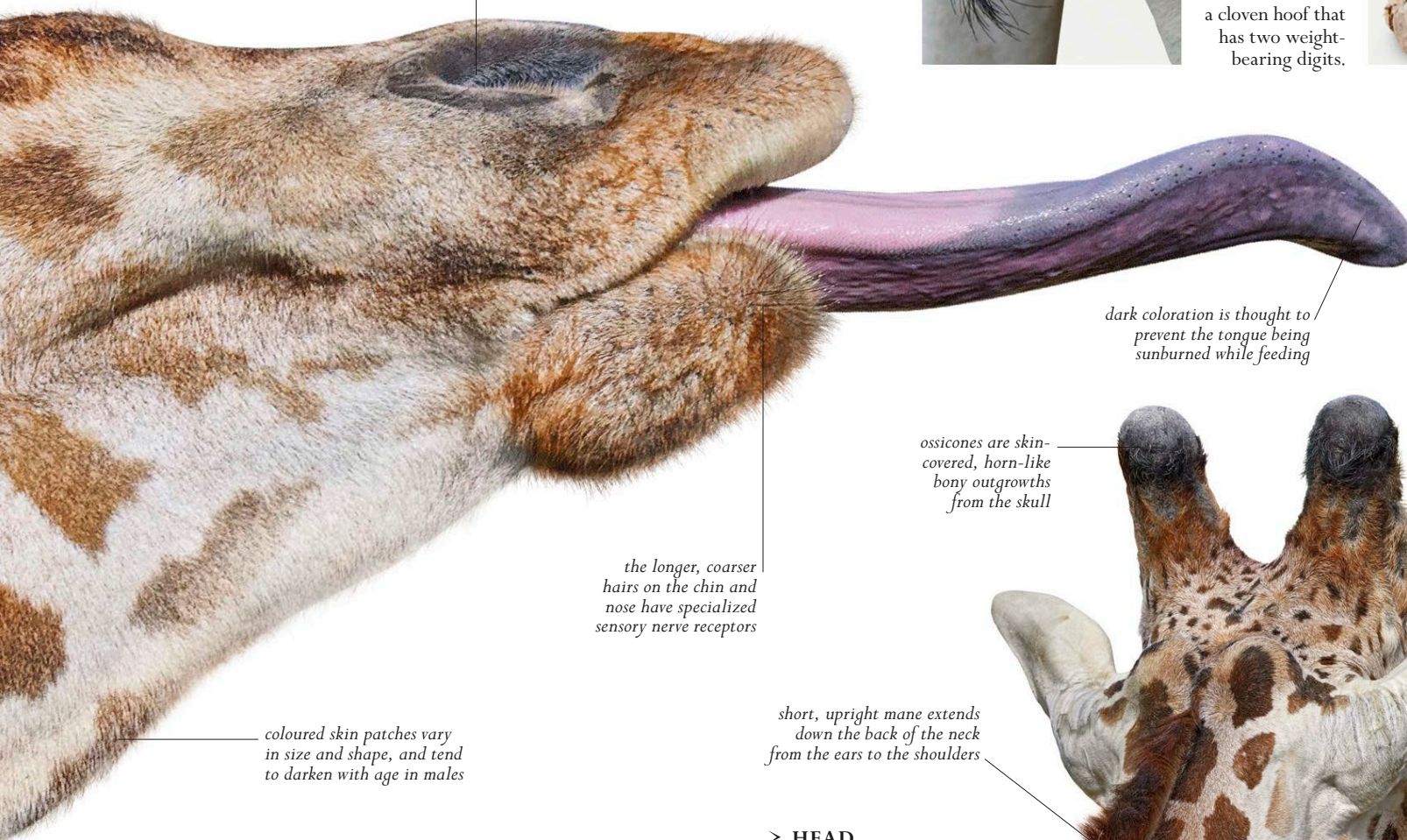
Dark skin patches have large sweat glands that help maintain a constant body temperature by dissipating heat.



FOOT >

Each elongated leg ends in a foot with a cloven hoof that has two weight-bearing digits.

giraffes have a good sense of smell



dark coloration is thought to prevent the tongue being sunburned while feeding

ossicones are skin-covered, horn-like bony outgrowths from the skull

the longer, coarser hairs on the chin and nose have specialized sensory nerve receptors

coloured skin patches vary in size and shape, and tend to darken with age in males

short, upright mane extends down the back of the neck from the ears to the shoulders

^ AT FULL STRETCH

A long neck, head, and tongue allow a giraffe to browse from trees that few other mammals can reach, thereby reducing competition for food. Having a long face also helps protect the eyes from thorns while feeding.

> HEAD

All giraffes have two ossicones that are soft at birth but gradually harden as calcium builds up. Male Rothschild's giraffes develop a third smaller ossicone on their forehead.

